

ASK A DOCTOR

My baby is in a posterior position. How will this affect my labor? In the posterior position, the baby faces your belly instead of your spine (see [Lie and presentation](#)). This position may prolong your labor, and cause more of a backache.

Most of the time, the baby turns into an anterior position, with the help of contractions as the head descends down the birth canal. If the baby doesn't turn on their own, your obstetrician may be able to gently turn their head, or use [forceps](#) or a [vacuum](#); occasionally a Cesarean birth may be needed.